

# Shakespeare's London

10 Canonical Locations · 2.5 Hours · Bankside to the City

Shakespeare's London still exists in patches — the street where he lodged, the site of the Globe, the tavern where his company drank. This walk traces the actual places, not the tourist replicas.

YOU SAVE: £147 vs guided tours

### ■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

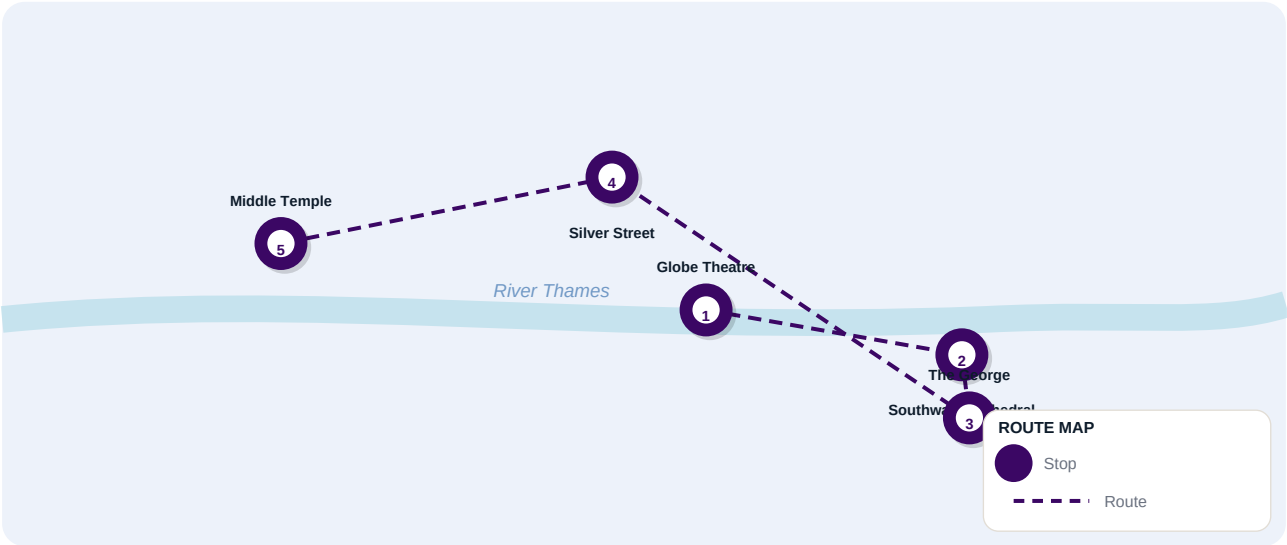
Retail price of this guide  
**£12.99**

Equivalent guided tours  
**£160**

YOUR SAVING  
**£147**

| ROUTE INFO   |                                                                |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ Start      | Globe Theatre & Park — Original Site (Bankside)                |
| ■ End        | Middle Temple Hall — Shakespeare's Stage (Temple)              |
| ■ Duration   | 2.5 Hours                                                      |
| ■ Transport  | From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops |
| ■ Total Cost | Guide: £12.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs    |

### SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



### PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location

|                       |                                                                              |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ■ <b>Saving</b>       | Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person            |
| ■ <b>Offline map</b>  | Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel                       |
| ■ <b>Transport</b>    | Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10) |
| ■ <b>Members only</b> | This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers                  |

■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — SHAKESPEARE'S LONDON

Follow stops 1→5 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1

### Globe Theatre & Park — Original Site

Bankside · Theatre season May–Oct. Exhibition daily 10am–5pm

■ START HERE

**HIDDEN TIP**

The reconstructed Globe (1997) is 230 metres from the original site — a plaque marks the exact location on Park Street. Standing tickets (called 'groundlings' as in Shakespeare's day) cost £5 — the most authentic theatrical experience in London and the cheapest way to see a Shakespeare play.

■ **SAVING**

West End Shakespeare: £60–90. Globe groundling: £5. Saving: £55+

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

London Bridge (10 min walk) or  
**Cost: Zone 1**

**DO THIS:**

- ✓ £5 groundling tickets — standing in front of the stage
- ✓ The free exhibition (ground floor, no ticket needed)
- ✓ Find the original Globe site plaque on Park Street

■ Best: Groundling standing tickets: May–October · Catch the matinée

**AVOID:**

Paying for seated tickets without checking groundling availability

★★★★★

**Free outside · £5-25 standing/seated**

2

### Southwark Cathedral — Shakespeare's Burial Place

Bankside · Daily 8am–6pm

■ 8 min walk east

**HIDDEN TIP**

Shakespeare's brother Edmund is buried here (died 1607). The Cathedral contains a Shakespeare Memorial — a recumbent alabaster effigy (1912) in the exact location where he'd have worshipped. The stained glass windows behind the effigy depict scenes from the plays.

■ **SAVING**

Free entry. Shakespeare literary tours: £20. Saving: £20

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

London Bridge (3 min walk)  
**Cost: Zone 1**

**DO THIS:**

- ✓ Find Edmund Shakespeare's burial record
- ✓ The Shakespeare Memorial — less visited than the Globe
- ✓ The medieval retrochoir — unchanged since Shakespeare's time

■ Best: Weekday morning — very quiet

**AVOID:**

Lunchtime — borough market tourists pass through

★★★★★

**Free**

3



## The George Inn — Shakespeare's London

■ 5 min walk south

Borough · Mon–Thu 11am–11pm, Fri–Sat 11am–midnight, Sun 12–10:30pm

### HIDDEN TIP

London's last surviving galleried coaching inn (1676, rebuilt after fire on original footprint). The National Trust owns it. Shakespeare drank at the original inn — his publisher operated nearby. Shakespeare Company possibly performed in the courtyard. Free to walk through; drink here if you can.

#### ■ SAVING

Free entry. Shakespeare-themed experiences: £30+. Saving: £30

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

London Bridge (5 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

#### DO THIS:

- ✓ Sit in the open courtyard — medieval inn experience
- ✓ Order a pint of ale — authentic experience
- ✓ Read the National Trust history boards in the gallery
- Best: Midday on a weekday — quiet and atmospheric

#### AVOID:

Weekend evenings — very crowded

★★★★★

Free entry

4



## Silver Street — Shakespeare's Lost London

■ 25 min or tube

City of London · Always accessible

### HIDDEN TIP

Shakespeare lodged at the house of Christopher Mountjoy, a French Huguenot tiremaker, at the corner of Silver Street and Monkwell Street (now Wood Street/Noble Street area, City). The house is gone but the street pattern is unchanged. A blue plaque at Wood Street marks the spot.

#### ■ SAVING

Free self-guided vs £20 guided walk.  
Saving: £20

#### ■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Barbican (5 min walk) or St Paul's (7 min walk)  
Cost: Zone 1

#### DO THIS:

- ✓ Find the Wood Street blue plaque
- ✓ Walk the unchanged medieval street pattern
- ✓ St Alban's church tower (Wren) survives nearby — Shakespeare era ...
- Best: Any time — street locations

#### AVOID:

Nothing — quiet and pleasant

★★★★■

Free



# Middle Temple Hall — Shakespeare's Court

■ 20 min walk

Temple · Mon–Fri 10am–4pm when courts not in session

**HIDDEN TIP**

Twelfth Night received its first recorded performance in this hall on 2 February 1602 — the actual original hall, unchanged. The double hammer-beam roof is Elizabethan. The hall is open to the public outside legal terms. You can stand exactly where Shakespeare's play was first performed.

■ **SAVING**

Free entry. Temple Inns guided tours: £12.  
Saving: £12

■ **CHEAPEST TRANSPORT**

Temple (3 min walk)  
**Cost: Zone 1**

**DO THIS:**

- ✓ Stand in the original performance space
  - ✓ The double hammer-beam roof — Elizabethan masterpiece
  - ✓ The high table where Queen Elizabeth I dined
- Best: Public access days — check [middletemple.org.uk](http://middletemple.org.uk)

**AVOID:**

During legal term without checking access

★★★★★

**Free (public access)**

# QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

| # | Name                      | Area           | Walk           | Cost       | Tube               | Rating |
|---|---------------------------|----------------|----------------|------------|--------------------|--------|
| 1 | Globe Theatre & Park —... | Bankside       | Start here     | Free outsi | London Bridge (10  | ★★★★★  |
| 2 | Southwark Cathedral — ... | Bankside       | 8 min walk eas | Free       | London Bridge (3 m | ★★★★★  |
| 3 | The George Inn — Shake... | Borough        | 5 min walk sou | Free entry | London Bridge (5 m | ★★★★★  |
| 4 | Silver Street — Shakes... | City of London | 25 min or tube | Free       | Barbican (5 min wa | ★★★★■  |
| 5 | Middle Temple Hall — S... | Temple         | 20 min walk    | Free (publ | Temple (3 min walk | ★★★★★  |

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